

LIVE

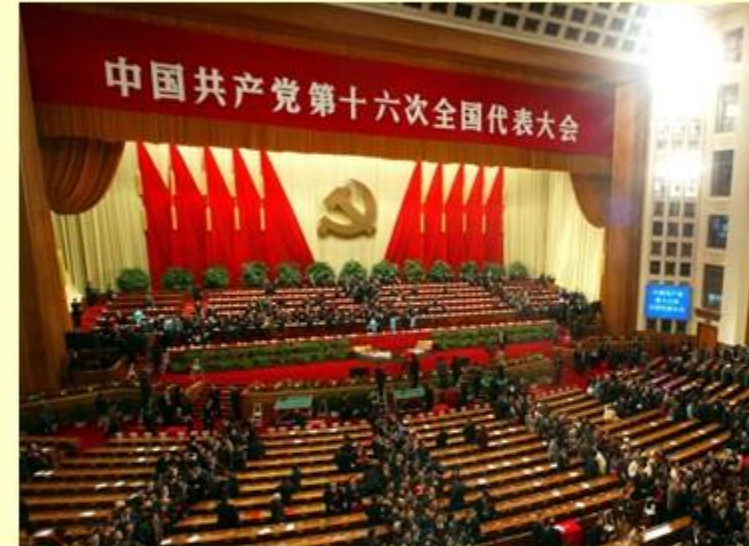
Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

5th March, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

10th WEEK



XI JINPING UNLIMITED

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.

2

Xi unlimited

With the presidential term limit set to go, Xi Jinping's rise takes China into a new era

The Chinese Communist Party's proposal to abolish term limits on the presidency, and thereby allow Xi Jinping to stay on in power beyond 2023 when his second term ends, is not completely unexpected. When he was re-elected party chief and President for a second term in October, no one was projected as a potential successor. This was a break with tradition and triggered speculation about him remaining President beyond the second term. Mr. Xi is arguably the most powerful leader of China since Mao Zedong. At the 19th Party Congress in October, "Xi Jinping Thought on Socialism with Chinese Characteristics for a New Era" was written into the party charter, setting him apart from his recent predecessors. He does not just control the main pillars of the Chinese state – the party, the government and the military. In 2016, the party accorded him special stature by making him the "Core Leader". Just as Deng Xiaoping oversaw China's economic rise, Mr. Xi has raised its profile in global geopolitics. He has pursued a more assertive foreign policy in China's neighbourhood and launched massive infrastructure programmes across the world as part of the Belt and Road Initiative. But despite the power amassed, long-term projects launched and his own apparent ambitions, the constitution was seen as a limit to his stint in power. With the latest proposal on removing the term limit, which is certain to be endorsed by parliament, Mr. Xi may find greater room for manoeuvre in speeding up the next generation of economic reforms.

The timing of the announcement itself, however, has taken many by surprise. Mr. Xi was about to begin his second term as President next month, and so has five years to introduce the constitutional changes needed. But with a proposal moved to amend the constitution a week ahead of a People's Congress convention, Mr. Xi has made it clear he does not want to leave anything to chance while consolidating his position. At present there is no rival power centre within the Communist Party to challenge Mr. Xi. But the centralisation of so much power in one individual, which is the antithesis of China's professed commitment to 'collective leadership', may well impact the power dynamics, given the succession battles of the past. The party introduced the term limit in the post-Deng era principally to bring in order and stability at a time when China was becoming an economic powerhouse. Two of Mr. Xi's immediate predecessors stepped down after their second term, having groomed the next generation of leaders, including Mr. Xi. By breaking with this pattern, Mr. Xi risks taking China back to the days of personality cults, internal power struggles and possibly chaotic successions.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

27th February, 2018

Emperor Xi Jinping

End to term limits for China's president will move it further down autocratic path

In a move that is bound to have significant ramifications for China, with possible fallout for the rest of the world, the Chinese Communist Party has proposed an amendment to China's constitution that will scrap term limits for the posts of president and vice-president. Currently they are entitled to serve a maximum of two consecutive terms in office, a practice institutionalised by China's 1982 constitution. The move to scrap this provision is widely being seen as a measure to ensure that current President Xi Jinping remains in office beyond 2023, with no limit prescribed.

There's no denying that since he assumed the top post in the Chinese political hierarchy in 2012-13, Xi has been steadily consolidating power. Over the last five years, Xi's massive anti-corruption purge has netted more than a million officials, generals and politicians. Conveniently the graft drive also swept aside most of Xi's potential rivals, giving him a free hand to stamp his authority on the party-state system.

But this accumulation of power by Xi subverts a 30-year-old understanding on collective leadership within the Chinese Communist Party. There could be two reasons for this – either Xi himself is afraid of being purged once he demits office or the Chinese system has simply run its course. In fact, it's quite possible that consensual one-party leadership – an oddity in a communist country – only worked in an environment of continuous high growth. But with the Chinese economy slowing down and a burgeoning Chinese middle class demanding much more from government, the party-state system is up against massive contradictions. Xi perhaps feels he can handle them only by tightening his hold on power.

New Delhi can only view this with a sense of foreboding, particularly with China projecting power into the Arabian Sea and looking to establish a base in the Maldives. One question that should be asked in this regard is why China tilts towards Pakistan rather than India in the subcontinent when India offers far greater commercial opportunities. Perhaps China finds large democracies like India threatening and in need of restraint, while semi-autocracies like Pakistan look more manageable. If that's how the cookie crumbles, India will have to coordinate more with the US, Japan and Western democracies. In the battle of political ideas, lines may get sharply drawn as Xi consolidates power in his hands. India will not be able to sit that one out with its erstwhile 'non-aligned' template.



THE TIMES OF INDIA

27th February, 2018

2

Xi unlimited

With the presidential term limit set to go,
Xi Jinping's rise takes China into a new era

The Chinese Communist Party's proposal to abolish term limits on the presidency, and thereby allow Xi Jinping to stay on in power beyond 2023 when his second term ends, is not completely unexpected. When he was re-elected party chief and President for a second term in October, no one was projected as a potential successor. This was a break with tradition and triggered speculation about him remaining President beyond the second term. Mr. Xi is arguably the most powerful leader of China since Mao Zedong. At the 19th Party Congress in October, "Xi Jinping Thought on Socialism with Chinese Characteristics for a New Era" was written into the party charter, setting him apart from his recent predecessors. He does not just control the main pillars of the Chinese state – the party, the government and the military. In 2016, the party accorded him special stature by making him the "Core Leader". Just as Deng Xiaoping oversaw China's economic rise, Mr. Xi has raised its profile in global geopolitics. He has pursued a more assertive foreign policy in China's neighbourhood and launched massive infrastructure programmes across the world as part of the Belt and Road Initiative. But despite the power amassed, long-term projects launched and his own apparent ambitions, the constitution was seen as a limit to his stint in power. With the latest proposal on removing the term limit, which is certain to be endorsed by parliament, Mr. Xi may find greater room for manoeuvre in speeding up the next generation of economic reforms.

The timing of the announcement itself, however, has taken many by surprise. Mr. Xi was about to begin his second term as President next month, and so has five years to introduce the constitutional changes needed. But with a proposal moved to amend the constitution a week ahead of a People's Congress convention, Mr. Xi has made it clear he does not want to leave anything to chance while consolidating his position. At present there is no rival power centre within the Communist Party to challenge Mr. Xi. But the centralisation of so much power in one individual, which is the antithesis of China's professed commitment to 'collective leadership', may well impact the power dynamics, given the succession battles of the past. The party introduced the term limit in the post-Deng era principally to bring in order and stability at a time when China was becoming an economic powerhouse. Two of Mr. Xi's immediate predecessors stepped down after their second term, having groomed the next generation of leaders, including Mr. Xi. By breaking with this pattern, Mr. Xi risks taking China back to the days of personality cults, internal power struggles and possibly chaotic successions.

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... Effect of Policies and Politics of Developing Countries on India's Interests.

2 Xi unlimited

With the presidential term limit set to go, Xi Jinping's rise takes China into a new era.

The Chinese Communist Party's proposal to abolish term limits on the presidency, and thereby allow Xi Jinping to stay on in power beyond 2023 when his second term ends, is not completely unexpected. When he was re-elected party chief and President for a second term in October, no one was projected as a potential successor. This was a break with tradition and triggered speculation about him remaining President beyond the second term. Mr. Xi is arguably the most powerful leader of China since Mao Zedong. At the 19th Party Congress in October, "Xi Jinping Thought on Socialism with Chinese Characteristics for a New Era" was written into the party charter, setting him apart from his recent predecessors. He does not just control the main pillars of the Chinese state — the party, the government and the military. In 2016, the party accorded him special stature by making him the "Core Leader". Just as Deng Xiaoping oversaw China's economic rise, Mr. Xi has raised its profile in global geopolitics. He has pursued a more assertive foreign policy in China's neighbourhood and launched massive infrastructure programmes across the world as part of the Belt and Road Initiative. But despite the power amassed, long-term projects launched and his own apparent ambitions, the constitution was seen as a limit to his stint in power. With the latest proposal on removing the term limit, which is certain to be endorsed by parliament, Mr. Xi may find greater room for manoeuvre in speeding up the next generation of economic reforms.

...Contd.



2 Xi unlimited

The timing of the announcement itself, however, has taken many by surprise. Mr. Xi was about to begin his second term as President next month, and so has five years to introduce the constitutional changes needed. But with a proposal moved to amend the constitution a week ahead of a People's Congress convention, Mr. Xi has made it clear he does not want to leave anything to chance while consolidating his position. At present there is no rival power centre within the Communist Party to challenge Mr. Xi. But the centralisation of so much power in one individual, which is the antithesis of China's professed commitment to 'collective leadership', may well impact the power dynamics, given the succession battles of the past. The party introduced the term limit in the post-Deng era principally to bring in order and stability at a time when China was becoming an economic powerhouse. Two of Mr. Xi's immediate predecessors stepped down after their second term, having groomed the next generation of leaders, including Mr. Xi. By breaking with this pattern, Mr. Xi risks taking China back to the days of personality cults, internal power struggles and possibly chaotic successions.

...Contd.



2 Emperor Xi Jinping:

End to term limits for China's president will move it further down autocratic path.

In a move that is bound to have significant ramifications for China, with possible fallout for the rest of the world, the Chinese Communist Party has proposed an amendment to China's constitution that will scrap term limits for the posts of president and vice-president. Currently they are entitled to serve a maximum of two consecutive terms in office, a practice institutionalised by China's 1982 constitution. The move to scrap this provision is widely being seen as a measure to ensure that current President Xi Jinping remains in office beyond 2023, with no limit prescribed.

There's no denying that since he assumed the top post in the Chinese political hierarchy in 2012-13, Xi has been steadily consolidating power. Over the last five years, Xi's massive anti-corruption purge has netted more than a million officials, generals and politicians. Conveniently, the graft drive also swept aside most of Xi's potential rivals, giving him a free hand to stamp his authority on the party-state system.

But this accumulation of power by Xi subverts a 30-year-old understanding on collective leadership within the Chinese Communist Party. There could be two reasons for this – either Xi himself is afraid of being purged once he demits office or the Chinese system has simply run its course. In fact, it's quite possible that consensual one-party leadership – an oddity in a communist country – only worked in an environment of continuous high growth. But with the Chinese economy slowing down and a burgeoning Chinese middle class demanding much more from government, the party-state system is up against massive contradictions. Xi perhaps feels he can handle them only by tightening his hold on power.

...Contd.



2 Emperor Xi Jinping:

New Delhi can only view this with a sense of foreboding, particularly with China projecting power into the Arabian Sea and looking to establish a base in the Maldives. One question that should be asked in this regard is why China tilts towards Pakistan rather than India in the subcontinent when India offers far greater commercial opportunities. Perhaps China finds large democracies like India threatening and in need of restraint, while semi-autocracies like Pakistan look more manageable. If that's how the cookie crumbles, India will have to coordinate more with the US, Japan and Western democracies. In the battle of political ideas, lines may get sharply drawn as Xi consolidates power in his hands. India will not be able to sit that one out with its erstwhile 'non-aligned' template.



MONGOLIA

CHINA

Sea of Japan

North Korea

South Korea

JAPAN

East China Sea

NEPAL

INDIA

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

VIETNAM

Lao PDR

BANGLADESH

KAZAKHSTAN

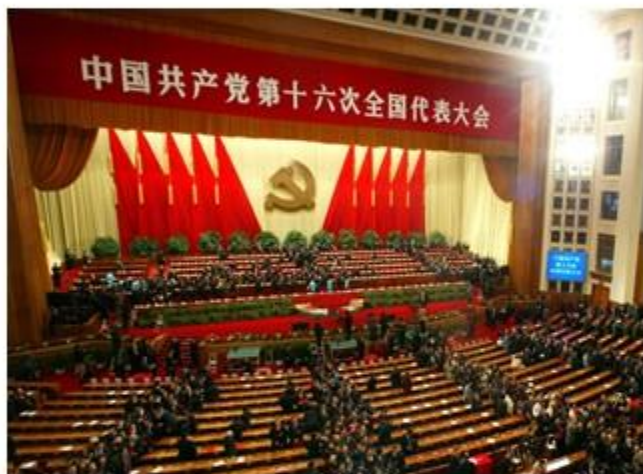
KYRGYZSTAN

TAJIKISTAN

AFGHANISTAN

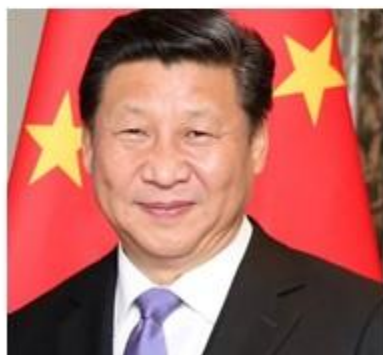
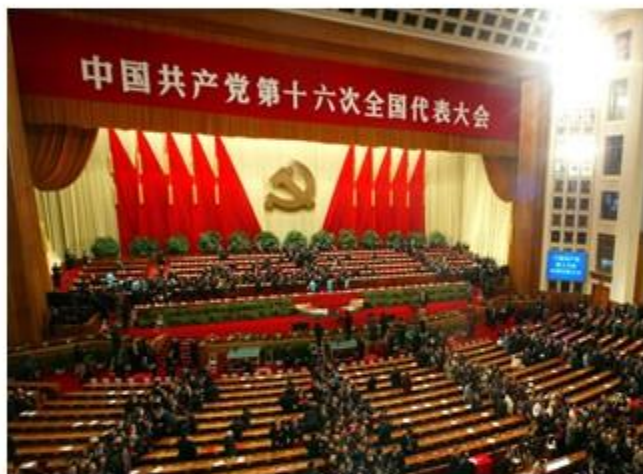
PAKISTAN

19TH NATIONAL CONGRESS OF CPC... XI JINPING BECAME MORE POWERFUL



- 1 Party Congress made special emphasis on strong military 'capable of winning the wars'.
- 2 It reinforces Mr. Xi as the paramount leader.
- 3 Mr. Xi made ambitions to restore its global leadership and dominance in the region.
- 4 He used the term China as a "great power" at least 25 times during his speech.

19TH NATIONAL CONGRESS OF CPC... XI JINPING BECAME MORE POWERFUL



- 5 His speech clearly talks about China's global ambitions.
- 6 The Congress planned to build global combat capabilities to safeguard China's overseas interests
- 7 China's military would be made world class in every way.

China is in no mood to compromise and "any attempt to contain China would be effectively met", in the words of the Congress.

CHINA IN A MORE ADVANTAGEOUS POSITION



- 1 It is the most important trade partner for over 90 countries.
- 2 It is a major lender across the world.
- 3 BRI caught the imagination of the world including that of Europe.
- 4 Several countries in Asia and Europe, including many of India's neighbours do not seem to have a problem with the BRI.

Economic might of China with its further global ambitions is the important aspect to note by the world community.



Xi Jinping

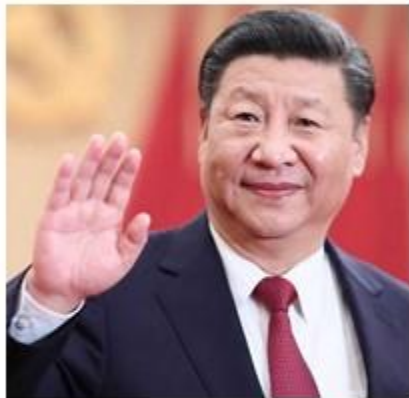


Deng Xiaoping

XI JINPING THOUGHT ON SOCIALISM WITH CHINESE CHARACTERISTICS

- 1** In Mr. Xi's World view, China has passed two eras. The revolutionary era was launched by Mao and the economic reforms spearheaded by Deng Xiaoping.
- 2** Now, Mr. Xi thought on socialism with Chinese characteristics for a New Era has gone in to the party charter.
- 3** This is about making China economically stronger and geopolitically more influential.

NEWS REPORT



XI JINPING
President, China

1 The Chinese Communist Party proposed to abolish term limits on the Presidency. It allows Xi Jinping to stay on in power beyond 2023, when his second term ends.

2 This was very clear even in October itself, when he got re-elected as party Chief and President. In fact no one was projected as a potential successor.

3 This was a break with tradition and triggered speculation about remaining as President beyond the second term.

4 He not only controls the party, the Government, the military, but also he was accorded special stature as "Core Leader" in 2016.

5 He raised China's profile in global geopolitics. He also pursued a more Assertive Foreign Policy.



JIANG ZEMIN

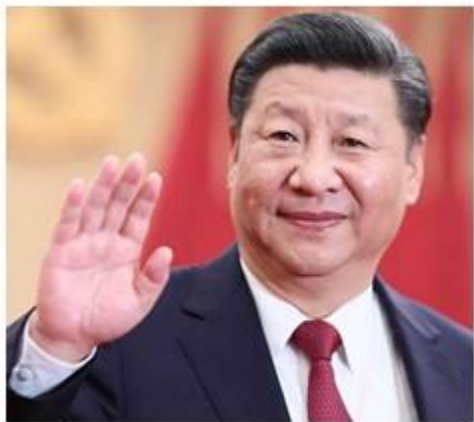


HU JINTAO

WHY SO SACROSANCT ABOUT TEN YEARS?

- 1** The tradition of limiting Presidencies to ten years emerged in 1990s.
- 2** The two predecessors of Xi Jinping, Jiang Zemin, and Hu Jintao, each served ten year terms.
- 3** It is unclear how long Xi's tenure will be in future.

Mr. Xi Jinping has already become the most powerful Chinese leader since Mao Zedong.



WHAT ARE ITS CONSEQUENCES?

- 1 At present, there is no rival power centre within the Communist Party to challenge Mr. Xi. But, the centralisation of so much power in one individual, which is the antithesis of China's professed commitment to "Collective Leadership" may well impact the power dynamics.
- 2 Post Deng Xiaoping, the party introduced the two-term limit to bring stability at a time, when China was becoming an economic powerhouse.
- 3 Two of the Mr. Xi's immediate predecessors stepped down after their second term.



MAO ZEDONG DENG XIAOPING

Breaking this pattern, it appears that Mr. Xi is taking China back to the days of personality cults, internal power struggles and possibly chaotic successions.



XI JINPING
President, China

WHAT IS THE PROPOSAL OF COMMUNIST PARTY OF CHINA?

- 1 Communist Party of China proposed that the President and Vice-President will not be Constitutionally restricted to two consecutive terms in office.
- 2 Hence, Xi Jinping, who is serving as second consecutive five year term can continue beyond 2023.
- 3 It is felt that due to the massive changes in Government and with more to come, it is probable that to implement these changes and let them take roots, he will need more time.



WHAT ARE THE OTHER PROPOSALS OF THE PARTY?

- 1 The Party proposed that Mr. Xi Jinping's political theory that is "Xi Jinping thought on Socialism with Chinese characteristics for a New Era", will be written into the Constitution.
- 2 Moreover, the formation of National Supervisory Commission, as a Constitutional entity, was also planned.

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9